

Pickup address input — which option?

Choosing how customers enter a custom pickup address when they're not at one of your 77 listed hotels.

Prepared for Casa Venturas · 2026-04-19 · Project: micasaventuras.com rebuild · Requires ~5 min to decide

The problem

Today's El Yunque pickup field on the new website offers two paths:

1. **Listed hotel** — customer searches from the 77 hotels you configured in Bókun (autocomplete works, 1-click selection, good UX).
2. **Custom address** — customer clicks "*Not staying at a listed hotel?*" and types their address in a free text box.

The free text box is functional but has real problems:

Risk 1 — typos and incomplete addresses. "calle loiza" vs "Calle Loíza 1510" vs "1510 Loíza St.". Your driver on the day of the tour has to guess the right one.

Risk 2 — addresses outside your service area. Nothing stops a customer from typing a Dorado or Humacao address. You discover it the night before, and have to cancel.

Risk 3 — no GPS coordinates. Driver cannot tap the address in Waze or Google Maps — has to search manually each time, losing 2–3 minutes per pickup.

We want to add an **address autocomplete** — the same thing you see on Uber or Airbnb: as the customer types, real Puerto Rico addresses appear; they pick one; we store it accurately with GPS coordinates.

How the UX changes

TODAY (FREE TEXT)

PICKUP ADDRESS

Street, number, neighborhood...

What customer types ends up exactly as-is in your Bókun notes, whatever they wrote.

WITH AUTOCOMPLETE (PROPOSED)

PICKUP ADDRESS

calle loiza

📍 1510 Calle Loíza, San Juan, PR 00911

📍 2301 Calle Loíza, San Juan, PR 00911

📍 Calle Loíza, Ocean Park, San Juan

Customer picks a real address; we store street + zip + GPS in the Bókun booking notes. Your driver taps once to open Waze.

Four realistic options

OPTION	PROVIDER	COST AT 40 BOOKINGS/DAY	UX QUALITY	CLIENT SETUP NEEDED
A — Keep free text	None	\$0 / month	Basic, typo-prone	None
B — OpenStreetMap	OSM Nominatim (free open-source)	\$0 / month	Decent, Puerto Rico coverage lighter	None
C — Google Places ★ recommended	Google Maps Platform	\$0 / month (within free tier)	Best — universally familiar	API key + billing activation (~5 min)
D — Mapbox	Mapbox Search	~\$0–0.50 / month	Clean, modern	API key + billing (~5 min)

The numbers behind "within free tier"

We estimate ~5% of El Yunque bookings need a custom address (most guests stay at one of the 77 listed hotels).

ASSUMPTION	GOOGLE PLACES	MAPBOX
Free tier per month	28 500 sessions	100 000 sessions
Expected sessions / month (5% of 40 bookings × 30 d)	~60	~60
Headroom before paying	475× free tier	1,666× free tier

ASSUMPTION	GOOGLE PLACES	MAPBOX
Monthly bill at your volume	\$0	\$0

Even if Casa Venturas grew 100× in custom-address usage (6 000 sessions / month), the bill would still be approximately **\$0–2**. Google offers a \$200/month perpetual credit that covers all of Maps Platform.

Why we recommend Google Places

★ Recommendation: Option C — Google Places Autocomplete

Three concrete reasons, in priority order:

1. **Your drivers already use Google Maps / Waze.** When we save a Google place_id, the driver can tap the pickup from the Bókun dashboard and open Waze in one tap with exact coordinates. No guessing, no re-searching.
2. **Your customers recognize it instantly.** "Type your address, pick from the suggestions" is the exact pattern Uber, Airbnb, DoorDash, and every major app uses. Zero learning curve.
3. **It costs you \$0.** At 40 bookings/day (well above today's volume) with ~5% custom addresses, you'd use ~0.2% of Google's free tier.

What you need to do if you say YES to Google Places

1. Go to **console.cloud.google.com** (log in with any Google account — your personal Gmail works fine).
2. Create a new project called "*Casa Venturas Website*".
3. Enable the "**Places API (New)**" product — one click.
4. Create an **API key**.
5. **Restrict the key** (important — 2 minutes):
 - HTTP referrers: `https://micasaventuras.com/*` and `http://localhost:3737/*`
 - API restrictions: tick only "*Places API (New)*"
6. Activate billing — Google requires a credit card on file even for free usage. You'll never be charged at your volume. Set a **monthly budget alert at \$5** for paranoia.
7. Copy the key (looks like `AIzaSyXXXXX...`) and send it to us.

We plug it into the website, deploy, and the new autocomplete is live the same day.

The pros/cons of each option, side by side

A — Keep free text (do nothing)

PROS

- Zero work, zero cost
- Already shipped, proven to work

CONS

- Typos waste driver time every morning
- No GPS → hard to navigate
- Customers can book from outside your service area

B — OpenStreetMap (free, open-source)

PROS

- Zero cost, no billing setup
- Open data, no vendor lock-in

CONS

- Puerto Rico coverage thinner than Google — some small streets missing
- Rate limit of 1 request/second (a problem during peak booking times)
- Less polished autocomplete UX (slower, fewer suggestions)
- No place_id for deep-link into Waze

C — Google Places (recommended)

PROS

- Best Puerto Rico coverage (same data the USPS uses for shipping)
- Instant, universally-recognized UX
- place_id opens in Waze/Maps in one tap
- \$0/month at your volume, forever
- Optional geo-restriction (country: PR) — blocks non-Puerto-Rico addresses

CONS

- Requires a Google Cloud account + billing activation (~5 min)
- Vendor dependency — if Google changes pricing, you'd have to migrate (unlikely for years)

D — Mapbox Search

PROS

- Modern, clean UX — some designers prefer it to Google
- Slightly larger free tier than Google

CONS

- Less universally recognized than Google
- Puerto Rico coverage slightly weaker than Google
- Same setup work as Google (account + billing)

Decision

Just reply to us with one of:

- **"A"** — Keep the free text input. No changes. We ship the site as-is.
- **"B"** — I'd like the free OpenStreetMap option (slightly worse UX, zero setup).
- **"C"** — Go with Google Places — I'll send you the API key in a day or two.
- **"D"** — I want Mapbox — same setup as Google but on Mapbox.

If you pick C or D, we'll ship the autocomplete within a day of receiving your key. No impact on launch timing — the site can go live with free text first, then we swap to autocomplete whenever the key arrives.